



PAKISTAN PRIME MINISTER Y.R. GILANI (LEFT) AND MANMOHAN SINGH AT SHARM EL-SHEIKH

DELHI | Austere Diplomacy

The foreign ministers of India and Pakistan will meet in New York on September 26 on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly session to take stock of the stalled dialogue process. The talks, to be preceded by a meeting of the two foreign secretaries, are the first after Sharm el-Sheikh, and are not expected to lead to any concrete results. While India maintains that the talks will centre around terrorism, the spin from Islamabad is that all issues, including Kashmir, will be discussed. In a clear deviation from its non-dialogue policy post-26/11, the UPA Government has gone back on its stand. Secretary-level talks have been on despite New Delhi claiming that Islamabad is not serious about the 26/11 probe. India is unhappy that Mumbai attacks mastermind Hafiz Saeed has been put under house arrest on flimsy charges instead of the more serious charge regarding his role in the attacks and that he may be freed soon. South Block reports warn of more attacks from Pakistan and that 62 terror camps are still functional in that country. Infiltration and cross-border firing have also peaked amid Id celebrations. In the season of austerity, the UPA Government should be stringent in diplomatic parleys as well; in the absence of credible action by Pakistan on terror, dialogue is a wasteful political expenditure.

by Saurabh Shukla

62

terror camps that train militants are reportedly up and running in Pakistan despite India repeatedly seeking their shutdown.